OFFICIAL PROGRAM & RULES

THE INTERNATIONAL SPACE DOG SHOW

A Travelling Exhibition of Pets, Mascots, and Companion Creatures from Every Corner of Wildspace

Hosted this cycle at the Floating Pavilion, three days' sail coreward of the Rock of Bral.
All chartered crews, independent operators, and persons of quality welcome to enter.
Entrants need not be dogs. Entrants need not, strictly, be animals. The judges have seen worse.

What This Show Actually Is

Founded some one hundred and eighty years ago by the astral elf Ophelia Rask, who grew tired of watching the founding houses turn every gathering into a negotiating table and wanted one event where that was expressly, formally forbidden. Lady Rask presides still, the Astral Kennel Concordance having run the Show every cycle since under her own continued eye, and the no-business rule still holds on the judging floor, by long tradition rather than any enforceable law, which has somehow made it stick harder than a law would have.

It has become, almost by accident, the one place in known space where rival houses, independent crews, and everyone between them stand shoulder to shoulder and mean it, if only for the length of a judging round. Attendance is itself a kind of status. Winning, even a minor category, follows a name for seasons. One hundred and eighty years is long enough that nobody alive remembers a Wildspace without it.

This Cycle's Categories

Physical Lane, bracketed by size class (Tiny through Huge)

Best Presentation — *sponsored by House Delverane*
Coat, scale, carapace, plumage, whatever the species in question actually has, judged against its own kind's standard, never cross-species.

The Long Run — *sponsored by House Stoneward*
A timed obstacle course run in full gravity-plane conditions. Speed and composure both count.

The Proving Round — *sponsored by House Stoneward*
A supervised sparring trial between willing, evenly matched entrants, judged on skill and control. Ends at the first clean hit or clear dominance. No serious harm permitted.

Strength of Pull — *sponsored by House Stoneward*
A straightforward hauling and towing trial. Raw power, nothing more.

Fastest in Show — *sponsored by House Delverane*
A straight sprint, no obstacles, no course, just speed.

The Cargo Run — *sponsored by House Stoneward*
Hauling a sandbag load from one post to another and back. Strength and endurance both, judged on pace held, not a burst of it.

Open Field, species and size both irrelevant

Most Convincing Trick — *sponsored by House Vellum*
A trick is convincing if the record would support that the animal meant to do it.

Best Costume — *sponsored by House Nightbreeze*
Judged on craft, concept, and the entrant's own evident tolerance for wearing it.

Best Vocalization — *sponsored by the Concordance*
Song, call, cry, or signal, whatever the entrant actually makes. Judged on control and carrying power.

Each entrant may be registered for up to three categories, no more.

Best in Show

Not a category of its own, Best in Show is chosen by the full judging panel from among this cycle's category champions. This cycle's purse is sponsored in full by Lord Wendell Carraway, of his own house's generosity and at considerable personal expense, a gesture the committee is given to understand he will mention unprompted at every opportunity between now and the judging.

Purse: 20,000 gp

Honorary, Not Judged

Longest Serving Ship's Animal
Presented, not competed for, to the entrant with the longest verifiable charter-service record. The committee asks only for the paperwork.

(continued: the judging panel, past champions, and the rules)

This Cycle's Judging Panel

Two panels of three, by lane. No judge crosses between them.

Physical Lane

Magistrate Yevelda Thorn

House Delverane

A silver elf of considerable age and considerably more opinions, fixated on symmetry to the point of personal eccentricity. Known to disqualify an otherwise flawless entrant for one crooked whisker.

Commodore (Ret.) Ossian Vale

House Stoneward

A retired Stoneward patrol officer, blunt and unsentimental, respects raw competence over any amount of polish. The panel's hardest mark by a wide margin, and everyone knows it.

Baroness Isolde Fenmark

independent

Old money, and proud of it. Cares more for bloodline and lineage than for anything an entrant actually does on the floor, a real source of friction with judges who value raw skill over pedigree.

Open Field Lane

Madam Quill

House Nightbreeze

A gnome barely taller than most of the entrants, easily delighted and impossible to win over twice with the same trick. Takes meticulous, illegible notes throughout every round.

Factor Renshaw Vell

House Vellum

Aging and exacting, judges every entrant against precedent and the official record. If it hasn't happened before, he wants to know why it's happening now.

Professor Aldric Wren

independent

A scholar by training, values originality above all else, and is genuinely hard to impress with anything that reads as derivative of a prior winner.

A fifth chair sits, as ever, at the head of the judging table. It is not filled.

Ten Years of Best in Show

Cycle	Champion	Notes
Last cycle	**Oatmeal**	*golden retriever, entirely ordinary, proof the show doesn't only reward the exotic*
2 cycles back	**Vex**	*brass dragon hatchling*
3 cycles back	**Bramble**	*blink dog, a win the judges still privately dispute*
4 cycles back	**Kitty**	*tiny displacer beast kitten*
5 cycles back	**Bellows**	*juvenile hippogriff, won asleep, a program legend*
6 cycles back	**Anchor**	*hauling mastiff, "the honest work year"*
7 cycles back	**Needle**	*astral hamster*
8 cycles back	**Marmalade**	*orange tabby, didn't seem to notice winning*
9 cycles back	**Scuttle**	*trained giant beetle*
10 cycles back	**Dot**	*a space guppy in a floating bowl, "the year nobody saw it coming"*

Several past champions are entered again this cycle. A veteran rarely retires quietly.

Entry & Conduct, the Short Version

- Entry is open to any companion creature accompanied by a sponsoring crew, house, or individual of record.
- Entrants must be collected, non-hostile, and under control at all times, judges' own discretion applies.
- Each entrant may be registered for up to three categories, no more.
- Sabotage, bribery, or interference with another entrant is grounds for immediate disqualification, should the committee ever actually catch anyone at it.
- The committee's judging decisions are final, binding, and occasionally inexplicable.

The International Space Dog Show thanks you for your continued, baffling enthusiasm.